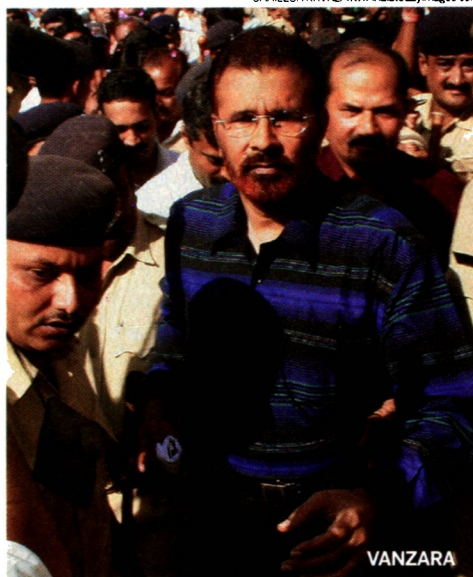


AHMEDABAD | The Plot Thickens

Here comes a revelation three years after IPS officers D.G. Vanzara and Raj Kumar Pandian of the Gujarat Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS) and Alwar SP M.N. Dinesh were jailed for their involvement in killing alleged terrorist Sohrabuddin Sheikh in an encounter. Pakistan-trained terrorist Mohammad Abdul Khwaja, who trained Muslim youth in terror attacks for the Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami (HUJI), has said that Vanzara and other officers of the Gujarat ATS were on the group's hitlist for their drive against Wahabi militant outfits. Hyderabad-native Khwaja, associated with terrorists involved in attacks in south India, was arrested last week. He said that the Gujarat police officers were in the HUJI's crosshairs after they nabbed Maulana Naseeruddin, a militant Wahabi preacher from Hyderabad, following a shootout in



2004. Khwaja's revelation comes at a time when pressure from human rights groups has made the Supreme Court hand over the Sohrabuddin case to the CBI.

by Uday Mahurkar

High Way

Despite the Sharm el-Sheikh fiasco, the choice of Shiv Shankar Menon as the National Security Adviser is a giveaway that Manmohan Singh will be the man in the driving seat on diplomacy, pushing his own agenda on Pakistan and China.

BHOPAL | Campus Politics



PAWAN BHAWAR

The Shivraj Singh Chouhan Government has mounted a political offensive against Rahul Gandhi's ambitious forays into Madhya Pradesh. Following the Congress general secretary's visit to

Devi Ahilya Vishwavidyalaya (DAVV) in Indore on January 19, the state BJP Government has asked the university's vice-chancellor why a political function was held on the campus. Ever since the death of professor H.S. Sabharwal during a students' body poll in Ujjain in 2006, the politicisation of campuses has become a very sensitive issue. Sources say Rahul was invited to the institutions by student groups. Congressmen say that the chancellor and Governor Rameshwar Thakur should have issued a notice, if at all. With Gandhi Junior taking his youth programme to the state, political sabre-rattling is likely to intensify in the days to come. by Ambresh Mishra

JAIPUR | Slow Motion

Ever since Ashok Gehlot began his second term as Rajasthan chief minister in 2008, his Government seems to be at a standstill. Be it framing policies, building new structures, setting up commissions or framing new laws, the Jaipur babus have not even achieved 10 per cent of

GEHLOT



the targets that were to be met during the financial year. Chief Secretary T. Srinivasan has now written to the principal secretaries, saying that Gehlot wants the budget proposals to be met by February 15. The finance department has ordered slashing the annual plan by Rs 1,300 crore; money will be released only if the departments can utilise it before March 31. Senior officers in the Gehlot administration are blaming general lethargy and biased selection of officials for the mess that the Gehlot Government is.

by Rohit Parihar